

PM Planning with Adam (02/27/2026)

News for Today

- PPI (MoM) (Jan) Actual (0.5%) Forecast (0.3%) Previous (0.4%) (8:30AM)
- Core PPI (MoM) (Jan) Actual (0.8%) Forecast (0.3%) Previous (0.6%) (8:30AM)
- Chicago PMI (Feb) Forecast (52.0) Previous (54.0) (9:45AM)
- Atlanta Fed GDPNow (Q1) Forecast (3.1%) Previous (3.1%) (11:30AM)
- \$NFLX (Netflix) —  +7.3%: Surged after deciding not to raise its bid for Warner Bros Discovery, increasing odds that Paramount Skydance wins the takeover battle.
- \$WBD (Warner Bros Discovery) —  -1.4%: Slipped as Netflix stepped back from increasing its offer.
- \$PSKY (Paramount Skydance) —  +6.4%: Gained as it appears to be the frontrunner in the bidding war.
- \$XYZ (Block) —  +20% Jumped after announcing plans to cut over 4,000 jobs to embed AI across operations.
- \$DELL (Dell Technologies) —  +12%: Beat Q4 expectations, benefiting from strong AI infrastructure demand.
- \$CRI (Carter's) —  -9.7%: Fell after issuing disappointing fiscal 2026 guidance.
- \$TGT (Target) —  -0.5%: Slipped after report it will require all cereals sold to exclude certified synthetic colors.
- \$CRWV (CoreWeave) —  -11%: Dropped on wider Q4 loss and weak margin performance despite higher revenue.

- \$FLTRF (Flutter Entertainment) — ● -13%: Fell after forecasting 2026 profit growth well below expectations.
 - \$ZS (Zscaler) — ● -9.6%: Declined despite earnings beat and solid outlook — investors wanted stronger guidance.
 - \$RKT (Rocket Companies) — ● +7.3%: Rose after topping Q4 revenue and earnings expectations with strong guidance.
 - \$INTU (Intuit) — ● -2.9%: Slipped after forecasting weaker Q3 profit despite stronger Q2 results.
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Market Overview — Friday, February 27, 2026

Futures Pointing Lower

U.S. stock futures are pointing lower to close out the week as investors digest heavyweight tech earnings and fresh twists in the AI narrative.

At 2:59 ET, Dow futures were down 205 points (-0.4%), S&P 500 futures slipped 0.2%, and Nasdaq 100 futures were hovering around flat — reflecting a cautious tone after a volatile tech session.

Wall Street finished mixed Thursday. The focus was squarely on Nvidia and Salesforce, with AI sentiment once again driving the tape.

Nvidia delivered another earnings beat, but shares still dropped more than 5% as investors questioned:

- How sustainable is AI-driven demand?
- When will massive cash generation translate into larger shareholder returns?
- Is competition quietly intensifying beneath the surface?



Meanwhile, Salesforce managed to rise despite issuing softer annual revenue guidance, as results were seen as “no worse than feared.” Analysts described the session as a “violent rotation” within tech, with money flowing out of physical AI plays (chips, data centers) and into software names.

AI remains the market’s core narrative — but the tone is shifting from pure momentum to scrutiny.

Paramount Likely Wins Warner Bros Battle

A major corporate saga appears close to resolution.

Netflix has walked away from its bid for Warner Bros. Discovery, clearing the path for Paramount Skydance to become the likely acquirer.

Paramount’s \$31-per-share offer for the entire company was deemed superior to Netflix’s \$27.75-per-share bid for Warner’s studios and HBO Max assets.

Netflix executives framed the deal as “nice to have — not must have,” signaling capital discipline over empire building.

If finalized, the deal would create a media powerhouse combining franchises like *Harry Potter* and *Game of Thrones* under Paramount’s umbrella.

Paramount shares rose in extended trading, while Warner Bros. dipped.

Anthropic vs. Pentagon

AI tension moved from Wall Street to Washington.

AI startup Anthropic is reportedly refusing Pentagon demands to remove safeguards that prevent its models from being used for:

- Domestic surveillance
- Autonomous weapons systems

Defense officials have threatened to end the partnership and classify the firm as a supply-chain risk if it doesn't comply.

CEO Dario Amodei stated he could not remove the guardrails "in good conscience," setting up a high-stakes standoff between national security priorities and AI ethics.

Block Cuts Half Its Workforce

Shares of Block surged more than 20% after the Jack Dorsey-led payments firm announced plans to cut roughly 4,000 jobs — nearly half its workforce.

The move is part of a sweeping overhaul to embed artificial intelligence more deeply across operations.

Dorsey said AI tools are fundamentally changing what it means to build and run a company, arguing a smaller team can now do more with intelligent automation.

Markets appear to be rewarding the margin expansion potential, despite restructuring costs that could reach \$500 million.

Oil Edges Higher

Oil prices ticked up slightly, but remain on track for muted weekly performance after U.S.-Iran nuclear talks concluded without a deal — though negotiations will continue next week.

- Brent: +0.7% to \$71.29
- WTI: +0.8% to \$65.74

Tensions around Iran have been a major driver of crude volatility this month, as the U.S. builds military presence in the Middle East while pressing Tehran for concessions.

For now, diplomacy continues — keeping a lid on supply shock fears.

Adam's Watchlist

- \$QQQ: Looking to go long off the 606.16's KL for a push up into the 609.90's KL and potentially the 615's KL. If we break below, I'll be going short off the 604's KL for a push down into the 600's KL and potentially the 596.36's KL.
 - \$DELL: Looking to go long off the 138.60's KL for a push up into the 144.35's KL.
 - \$NFLX: Looking to go long off the 92.55's KL for a push up into the 95's KL and potentially the 97.45's KL.
 - \$XYZ: Looking to go long off the 66.78's KL for a push up into the 70.80's KL.
 - \$AMZN: Looking to go long off the 206's KL for a push up into the 210.20's KL and potentially the 212.87's KL.
 - \$NEE: Looking to go long off the 92.48's KL for a push up into the 93.80's KL and potentially the 95.91's KL.
 - \$RXT: Looking to go long off the 150's KL for a push up into the 160's KL.
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⚡ COMMUNITY WATCHLIST ⚡

- \$EGO: Looking to go long off the 44.33's KL for a push up into the 46.22's KL and potentially the 48.08's KL.
 - \$RKT: Looking to go long off the 19.13's KL for a push up into the 20.33's KL.
 - \$PLTR: Looking to go long off the 135.50's KL for a push up into the 139.57's KL.
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